



AB InBev Healthcare Scheme

A Guide to Your Scheme

Effective from 01 April 2025

Budweiser

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A PROUD PART OF ABInBev

Welcome to your Healthcare Scheme

Welcome to **your** AB InBev Healthcare **Scheme**. Please take time to read through this **Guide** and keep it in a safe place.

You will want to know how to make best use of **your Scheme**. This **Guide** is here to help **you** and explains what **you** need to know about **your Scheme** and how to make a **claim**.

Your Scheme is provided by the AB InBev Healthcare Trustee Limited and is administered by WPA Protocol Plc (**Protocol**). **Your Scheme** recognises that private healthcare is a valuable and important benefit. People are a business's greatest asset and that's why **your Scheme** enables **Scheme Members** and their registered **family members** to have immediate access to medical care, ensuring a swifter return to work. **Your Scheme** provides the support of a helpdesk to give advice and assistance with service, focused on the highest levels of personal care and attention.

Our aim is to make the process of getting **treatment** and claiming the costs quick and simple, so that **you** may focus on **your treatment** and getting better, whilst **we** take care of the rest. **We** hope **you** will never need to use **us**, but if **you** do, **you** can be assured of personal assistance every step of the way.

If **you** change **your** mind

We are sure that **you** will be happy with the AB InBev Healthcare **Scheme** and the **benefits** that it provides. However, if **you** change **your** mind and wish to cancel **your Scheme** membership **you** must contact the **Scheme Holder**.

Cancelling Existing Healthcare Arrangements

Please thoroughly check all of **your Scheme** documentation before cancelling any other healthcare arrangement, insurance products or policies **you** already have. It is important that **you** understand what **your Scheme** provides, that it has the **benefits** **you** require and that membership of **your Scheme** meets **your** needs.

Information Provided

You have been accepted to join the **Scheme** based on the information **you** provided when **you** completed the **Application Form**; if **your** circumstances have changed since completing the **Application Form** it is important that **you** contact **us** to let **us** know. **We** reserve the right to end and/or amend **your Scheme** membership at any time should it transpire that **you** have not disclosed to **us** information and/or informed **us** of a change of circumstance that **you** ought to have done. This applies whether or not **you** completed the **Application Form** personally.

⚠ **Very Important Information**

As with all types of healthcare arrangement there are exclusions which are applicable generally and apply to every **benefit** within this **Guide**. **Our** general exclusions can be found in Section 6 (What is Not Eligible).

When using this **Guide** there are a number of things to remember:

- When **we** refer to "pay for" or "provide **benefit**" this is always to a level **we** consider to be a **customary and reasonable** cost.
- When **we** refer to **Specialist** or **Therapist** **we** mean a **Specialist** or **Therapist** **we** recognise.

- When **we** refer to **hospital** **we** mean a **hospital** on **our** list of recognised **hospitals**.
- **Your** proposed **treatment** must be in accordance with what **we** recognise as current medical practice and **we** call this **established treatment**.
- Any direct or indirect reference to a European body or provision may be superseded by a relevant **UK** body or provision.

Your Guide to your Scheme

Thank **you** for joining the AB InBev Healthcare Trust

References in this **Guide** to "**you**" or "**your**" are references to both **you** as the **Scheme Member** and any **family member(s)** included within **your Scheme** membership, and included on **your Certificate of Participation**. References to "**us**", "**we**" or "**our**" are to **Protocol**. All words and phrases with a defined meaning are shown in bold and italics, **we** suggest that **you** take a moment to review Section 8 (Definitions) of this **Guide**.

This **Guide** is important. It should be read in conjunction with **your Benefit Schedule** and **your Certificate of Participation** which, along with this **Guide**, explains **your** and **our** respective rights and obligations and sets out the terms and conditions of **your** health benefits. **Your Certificate of Participation** is personal to **you** and details any **personal exclusions** applicable. If **your Certificate of Participation** contains anything unusual or unexpected please contact **us** as soon as possible.

Please keep this **Guide**, **your Benefit Schedule** and **your Certificate of Participation** safe, **you** may need to refer to them should **you** need to make a **claim**. If **you** need a replacement document or have any other questions at all about **your Scheme** please do not hesitate to contact **us**.

How to get in touch with us

Contacting Us

WPA Health app:

To make a **claim** online using **our** smartphone app please visit the App Store for iPhone or Google Play for Android and download **our** WPA Health app. Please note that the app cannot be used to make administrative changes.

Website and Live Chat:

my.wpa.org.uk where **you** may register to view the details of and administer **your Scheme** and submit and view **claims**. Live chat functionality is also available within this area.

Telephone:

01823 625328 where **we** will be happy to assist.

Our calls are recorded for training and monitoring purposes and to ensure an accurate record of discussions.

Email:

protocol@wpa.org.uk

Post:

WPA Protocol Plc, Rivergate House, Blackbrook Park, Taunton, TA1 2PE.

If **you** would like this **Guide**, **your Benefit Schedule**, **your Certificate of Participation** or any other document issued by **Protocol** in an alternative format, please contact **us** and **we** will be happy to assist.

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1. Your Scheme

⚠ **Your Scheme provides benefit for eligible treatment, not your condition.**

1.1 Purpose of *your Scheme*

The purpose of *your Scheme* is to pay for the *customary and reasonable* cost of elective, short-term, *eligible treatment* for *acute conditions*. *Your eligible treatment* must be *established treatment* and provided with *curative intent*.

Your Scheme only provides *benefit* for *treatment* in the *UK*, except where the Overseas Emergency *Treatment Benefit* applies – see Section 5.4 (Overseas Emergency *Treatment*).

Your Scheme does not provide *benefit* for the long-term monitoring, management or *treatment* of incurable, prolonged or lifelong conditions except for limited *benefit* where the Long-term (Chronic) Conditions *Benefit* has been included – see Section 4.2 (Long-term (Chronic) Conditions).

Your Scheme provides *benefit* for *eligible treatment* as it occurs and whilst *your Scheme* membership remains in force.

It is important to understand that *your Scheme* is not designed to be a replacement for the *NHS*, but rather to complement it.

1.2 How *your Scheme* Works

When *you* receive private medical *treatment*, a contract is formed between *you* as the patient and *your treatment* provider, be that the *Specialist, Therapist* or *hospital*.

A contract does not exist between *us* and *your treatment* provider. If payment is made directly to *your treatment* provider, it is made on *your* behalf.

1.3 How to use this *Guide*

This *Guide* details what is and is not provided by *your Scheme*. The *benefits* are illustrated as follows:

- ✓ This *benefit* is included subject to the terms and conditions of *your Scheme*.
- ✗ This *benefit* is not included under *your Scheme*.
- ⚠ Very important information.

Benefits should not be read in isolation and are subject to the terms and conditions contained in this *Guide*, *your Certificate of Participation* and *your Benefit Schedule*.

1. Your Scheme

1.4 Level of *Benefit*

Your level of *benefit* and *benefit* options are detailed on *your Benefit Schedule* and *your Certificate of Participation*.

Only the *Scheme Holder* at renewal may add or remove *benefits* to tailor *your Scheme*. The *Scheme Holder* may choose different *benefits* for *family member(s)*.

When reading the *benefits* the following symbols apply. Please check *your Benefit Schedule* for the applicable *benefit* limits.

-  This *benefit* is deducted from a mental health *benefit* limit.
-  This *benefit* is deducted from a primary care *benefit* limit.
-  This *benefit* is deducted from a therapy *benefit* limit.

1.5 Employment

We reserve the right to request satisfactory evidence of *your* employment status. *You* must notify *us* immediately if there is a change in *your* employment status as failure to do so will render *your Scheme* membership void.

2. Types of Care and Treatment

⚠ **Your Scheme only provides benefit for what we consider to be established treatment.**

2.1 *NHS* and Private *Treatment*

Your Scheme works alongside available *NHS treatment* and does not replace it. In an emergency, the *NHS* is best equipped to provide *treatment*. Membership of *your Scheme* enables *you* to obtain private *eligible treatment* where *you* prefer.

If *you* opt to have *NHS treatment* where no charge is made, *you* may be eligible to claim the *NHS Hospital Cash Benefit*.

All providers of private healthcare in the United Kingdom are required by law to submit data to the Private Healthcare Information Network (PHIN) as do some *NHS hospitals*. To assist *you* to make informed decisions about *treatment we* encourage *you* to visit the PHIN website www.phin.org.uk

2.2 *NICE*

The National Institute for Health & Care Excellence (*NICE*) is a national advisory body established by the Health and Social Care Act 2012.

Its purpose is to publish guidelines for the use of health technologies such as new and existing medicines, *treatments*, *procedures* and the *treatment* and care of specific conditions.

It does so on the basis of robust evidence taken from the spectrum of health and social care to help ensure that medical technologies which are adopted are effective.

In common with the *NHS* and other *Scheme* administrators, *Protocol* relies upon *NICE* as the definitive objective guide to patient efficacy and safety.

2.3 Primary Care

Primary care includes any tests or investigations that *your GP* needs to arrange in order to treat any condition or refer *you* to an appropriate *Specialist* or *Therapist* for secondary care. *Your Scheme* is primarily designed to pay for secondary and *hospital* care.

2.4 Secondary and *Hospital* Care

2.4.1 *Hospital Access*

You have access to an extensive choice of *hospitals* throughout the *UK*.

⚠ To search for a *hospital* in *your* area please visit my.wpa.org.uk and once *you* have signed in *you* will be able to find a *hospital*.

2.4.2 *Specialist Treatment*

Treatment given on the referral of *your GP* by a *Specialist*. This includes tests and investigations *your Specialist* needs to arrange to be able to make a diagnosis or determine *your treatment* plan.

2.4.3 *Therapist Treatment*

Treatment given on the referral of *your GP* or *Specialist* by a *Therapist*.

2. Types of Care and Treatment

2.5 Critical Care

2.5.1 Level 2 – High Dependency *Treatment*

Patients requiring more detailed observation (than in an ordinary *hospital* bed) or intervention including support for a single failing organ system or post-operative care, and those stepping down from higher levels of care.

2.5.2 Level 3 – Intensive Care *Treatment*

Patients requiring advanced respiratory support alone or monitoring and support for two or more organ systems. This level includes all complex patients requiring support for multi-organ failure.

2.6 Emergency *Treatment*

Unforeseen and unplanned *treatment* that is due to a sudden *acute condition* that for medical reasons cannot be delayed. In an emergency the *NHS* is best equipped to provide this *treatment*.

- ⚠ Once the *acute condition* is stabilised, typically after 24 hours, *you* may wish to transfer (to a private *hospital* or private unit of an *NHS hospital*) to receive private *eligible treatment* which must be arranged by a *Specialist* and be at *your* own request. *We* must authorise the transfer in advance otherwise no *benefit* will be available. *You* will only be eligible to receive private *treatment* with effect from the date *you* sign the private *hospital's* authorisation form or undertaking to pay form.
- ⊗ **We will not pay for:**
 - An emergency or unplanned admission into a private *hospital*.

3. Claims

- ⚠ **Your Scheme** pays for the **customary and reasonable** cost of **eligible treatment**.

If **your claim** has not been authorised by **us** in advance **we** will not pay it. Please see Sections 3.3-3.6 for further information which applies.

- ⚠ **We** may request further information to assess the eligibility of a **claim**. Where **we** request further information, **we** will be unable to confirm any authorisation of **your claim** and any **treatment** until this is received.

3.1 How to make a **Claim** for Private **Treatment**

This is how to make a **claim** for:

- **In-patient treatment**;
- **Day-patient treatment**; and
- **Out-patient treatment**.

Your Scheme only provides **benefit** for **treatment** in the **UK** except where the Overseas Emergency **Treatment Benefit** applies – see Section 5.4 (Overseas Emergency **Treatment**).

- ⚠ Please ensure **you** contact **us** in advance, to confirm that **we** will authorise **your claim** (**we** refer to this as pre-authorisation). To do this **you** can:
- Access the WPA Health app;
 - Login to **your** secure area at my.wpa.org.uk and follow the prompts under 'Make a **claim**';
 - Call **us** on the number shown at the beginning of this **Guide**. Lines are open Monday-Friday 8am-7pm and Saturday 9am-12pm.

Step 1

Visit **your GP**. **Your GP** must always be consulted first to provide primary care. In an emergency, seek **NHS treatment**.

Step 2

If **your GP** refers **you** to a **Specialist** or **Therapist**, when **you** contact **us** for pre-authorisation **please ensure that you have the name and address of the Specialist or Therapist that you need to see**. If **you do not have the name of a medical professional we can assist you with locating one**.

Self-referral via the Healthcare Pathways

If **you** do not have a **GP** or **Specialist** referral and wish to **claim** for physiotherapy, mental health **treatment** or **you** wish to utilise the **cancer** diagnosis pathway **you** may self-refer. When **you** contact **us**, **we** will take details of **your claim** and transfer **your** call through to the relevant Healthcare Pathway provider. Please see Section 4.6 (Healthcare Pathways).

Step 3

We will advise **you** of the **benefits** available and send the documentation to be completed by **you** and **your Specialist** or **Therapist** and returned to **us**. Based on this information, **we** will let **you** know in writing what is eligible and authorised.

Step 4

If **your Specialist** or **Therapist** recommends **treatment** outside of what has been authorised, or referral to another **Specialist** or **Therapist**, please contact **us** for further pre-authorisation.

- ⚠ For some **claims we** may ask for further information from **your NHS GP**.

3. Claims

⚠ Please ensure **you** submit **your claim** within six months of the **eligible treatment** date.

Please see Section 3.6 (**Claims Administration and Reimbursement**) for further information which applies.

3.2 How to make a **Claim** for a Cash **Benefit**

This Section outlines how to make a **claim** for:

- **NHS Hospital Cash Benefit**; and
- Any other cash **benefit** included under **your Scheme**.

To start **your claim**:

- Access the WPA Health app;
- Login to **your** secure area at my.wpa.org.uk and follow the prompts under 'Make a **claim**';
- Call **us** on the number shown at the beginning of this **Guide**. Lines are open Monday-Friday 8am-7pm and Saturday 9am-12pm.

Step 1

Use **our** WPA Health app, My WPA or call **us** on 01823 625328. **We** will let **you** know if **you** need to provide the information in Step 2.

Step 2

In some cases **you** may be prompted to complete and return a personalised **Claim Form** to **us** with the original invoices and proof of payment.

- To **claim NHS Hospital Cash Benefit** for **in-patient** and/or **day-patient treatment** **we** need a copy of **your** discharge summary.
- To **claim NHS Hospital Cash Benefit** for complex scans and/or **out-patient procedures** **we** need a copy of **your** appointment letter.
- To claim **NHS Hospital Cash Benefit (cancer)** for **out-patient cancer treatment**: radiotherapy/chemotherapy, **Targeted Cancer Therapies** and/or **out-patient blood tests** **we** need a copy of **your** appointment letter.
- For all other cash **benefit claims** **you** must include original invoices and proof of payment where applicable, by uploading them via **our** WPA Health app or My WPA (my.wpa.org.uk)

3. Claims

⚠ The information in Sections 3.3-3.5 relates to *claims* for private *treatment*.

3.3 Additional *Claims* Information

At each stage *you* seek pre-authorisation *we* will check:

- That *your Specialist* or *Therapist* is recognised by *us* and that the *hospital* is on *our* list of recognised *hospitals*;
- Whether *your* proposed *treatment* is eligible under *your Scheme* and advise *you* of the *benefits* available.

You must:

- Provide any information *we* require of *you*.

If *your Specialist* recommends *treatment* or referral to a *Therapist* ask for the associated *CCSD Code* for the *procedure* and the likely charge – see Section 3.4 (*Your Treatment Provider's Fees*).

- ⚠ *We* reserve the right at any time in *our* sole discretion to withdraw or amend *our* list of recognised *treatment* providers (this includes *hospitals*, *Specialists* and *Therapists*) and what *we* recognise as *established treatment*.

3.4 *Your Treatment Provider's Fees*

When *you* receive *treatment*, the contract is formed between *you* and the provider, be that a *hospital*, *Specialist* or a *Therapist*. A contract does not exist between *us* and *your treatment* provider.

We publish a *Fee Schedule* which sets out the maximum amount *we* will reimburse for services carried out by *your Specialist*. *Our Fee Schedule* may be viewed at any time at: wpa.org.uk/guidelines. *Our* fee reimbursement levels are set by *us* to reflect what *we* consider to be *customary and reasonable* by means of *our* continuing dialogue with the medical profession.

A *Specialist* may charge *you* more than *our* maximum reimbursement amount listed in *our Fee Schedule* and if *you* decide to proceed with that *Specialist* then it is *your* responsibility to settle the difference. *We* refer to this as a shortfall.

Most *procedures* are classified using *CCSD Codes*. *We* list all *CCSD Codes* in *our Fee Schedule*. If *your Specialist* tells *you* that *you* need a *procedure* ask them to let *you* know which code they will use and what their fee will be. *You* will then know whether their fee exceeds *our* fee level. If it does there will be a shortfall which *you* must pay.

For *Specialists* fees, reimbursement is available only for services carried out within the speciality noted against the *Specialist's* entry on the *GMC Specialist* Register.

- ⚠ If *you* are admitted to *hospital* please ask to see the *hospital* invoice when *you* leave. Whilst *you* may not understand every detail, some information is easily checked.

3. Claims

3.5 Shared Responsibility®

⚠ Shared Responsibility applies to all *claims* except:

- *NHS Hospital Cash Benefit*; and
- Hospice Donation.

Shared Responsibility applies per person per *Scheme Year*.

You will pay 10/25% of *claims* for *eligible treatment* up to *your* applicable level of Shared Responsibility. *We* will pay the other 90/75% of *claims* for *eligible treatment*. Please check *your Benefit Schedule* for the applicable Shared Responsibility limits.

Once *you* have paid *your* applicable Shared Responsibility level *we* will pay 100% thereafter of all *claims* for *eligible treatment* within *your benefit* limits for the remainder of the *Scheme Year*.

Payment of all *eligible treatment* costs within *your* Shared Responsibility level must be sent directly to *your treatment* provider(s).

⚠ *You* must still submit invoices to *us* once *you* have paid *your treatment* provider so that *we* know when *your* Shared Responsibility limit has been reached.

⚠ It is a term of *your Scheme* that Shared Responsibility is paid to *your treatment* provider(s).

⚠ *You* are not permitted to insure *your* Shared Responsibility level amount with an insurer.

3.6 Claims Administration and Reimbursement

⚠ The information in Section 3.6 relates to all *claims* for private *treatment*, *NHS Hospital Cash Benefit* and other cash *benefits*.

⚠ The fact that *we* have paid for a particular *treatment* in the past does not mean that *we* will continue to pay for it in the future.

We pay invoices in line with the terms and conditions of *your Scheme* which are in force on the date of *your treatment*, not on the date that *your* condition was first noticed or diagnosed.

If *your treatment* takes place after *your Scheme* membership ceases, no *benefit* will be available even if the condition for which *you* are receiving *treatment* for arose whilst *you* were a *Scheme Member*.

Where *we* reimburse via direct credit *we* will only pay in to a valid *UK* bank account held in the *Scheme Member's* name. Reimbursement for any *family member(s)* will be paid direct to the *Scheme Member*.

⊗ *Your Scheme* will not pay for any *treatment* or investigation:

- Given by a *treatment* provider who is related to *you*;
- Following a referral by a healthcare provider who is related to *you*;
- Carried out solely at *your* request and/or as a result of any inducement, financial or otherwise;
- Received outside of the *UK* (unless the Overseas Emergency *Treatment Benefit* applies to *your Scheme* membership);
- Paid in part or in full using vouchers or reward points;
- Not yet received, even if paid for in advance by *you*;
- For any form of subscription service.

3. Claims

For cash **benefit claims**, or if **you** have received and paid for any part of **your** private **eligible treatment**, and wish **us** to repay **you**, then **you** must send **us** the original invoice and proof of payment such as a valid, original credit card receipt (these will not be returned to **you**).

- ⊗ Handwritten receipts will not be accepted.

Original invoices must be received within six months of the date of the **treatment**, to enable the **Scheme Holder** to plan for future costs by understanding the past **Scheme** liabilities. Any cash **benefit** invoices received more than six months from the date of the **treatment** will therefore not be paid.

For cash **benefit claims** submitted online **you** must keep the associated invoice for at least six months, as **you** may be called upon to provide the invoice to **us**.

- ⚠ If **we** pay a **claim** in error, **we** will explain this to **you** and **we** reserve the right to recover all or part of the amount of the payment from **you**. This may include offsetting the amount of the payment made in error against any amount payable for future **claims**.

The amount of any **claim** that **you** make must not exceed the cost actually incurred by **you** for the **eligible treatment you** have received.

It is a general legal principle that **you** are not permitted to make a profit from **claims**.

You may not be paid more than once in respect of the same expense.

4. Benefits

In-patient

A patient who is admitted to a **hospital** and who occupies a bed overnight or longer for medical reasons.

Day-patient

A patient who is admitted to a **hospital** or **day-patient** unit for medical reasons and because they need a period of medically supervised recovery but do not occupy a bed overnight.

4.1 In-patient and Day-patient Treatment

- ⚠ These **benefits** are available for **eligible treatment** when **you** are referred by **your GP** to a **Specialist** we recognise. If **you** receive any of these **benefits** on the **NHS** please see Section 4.5 (**NHS Hospital Cash Benefit**). For **cancer** please see Section 4.4 (**Cancer Care**).

In-patient & Day-patient Treatment Benefit

✓ ***Hospital Treatment***

Accommodation charges and operating theatre fees. **You** may choose from an extensive choice of over 1,000 **hospitals**, clinics and scanning centres across the **UK** – including large private **hospital** groups, independent private **hospitals** and clinics and private wings of **NHS hospitals**.

✓ ***Critical Care Levels 2 and 3***

A maximum of 28 days/nights for **treatment** received in a dedicated private **Critical Care** Unit following a planned admission as a private patient to a private **hospital** or the private unit of an **NHS hospital** for **eligible treatment** that requires anticipated pre-planned **critical care**. See Section 2.5 (**Critical Care**).

✗ ***We will not pay for:***

- **Treatment** in a unit or facility which is not a dedicated private **Critical Care** Unit or any **Critical Care** Unit of an **NHS hospital** following transfer from a private **hospital**;
- Admission as a private patient to an **NHS Critical Care** Unit or into a private **hospital Critical Care** Unit following an emergency or unplanned admission.

✓ ***Drugs***

Drugs and dressings.

✓ ***Specialists' Fees***

Such as surgeons', physicians' and anaesthetists' fees provided **we** recognise the **Specialist** and the charges are a **customary and reasonable cost**.

✓ ***Diagnostic Tests***

Requested by **your Specialist**, such as blood tests, ultrasounds and x-rays to help find the cause of **your** symptoms.

✓ ***Complex Scans***

We will provide **benefit** for MRI, CT and PET scans when referred by **your Specialist**.

✓ ***In-patient and Day-patient Therapy***

Requested by **your Specialist** and relating to **your** authorised **claim** for **eligible treatment**:

- Dietary Services when treated by a dietitian on the Register of Dietitians of the **HCPC**;
- Physiotherapy when treated by a **Therapist** on the Register of Physiotherapists of the **HCPC**; and
- Speech and Language Therapy when treated by a **Therapist** on the Register of Speech and Language Therapists of the **HCPC**.

✓ ***Post-operative Consultation and Tests***

One follow-up consultation with **your Specialist** and associated tests carried out on the day of that consultation, including drugs and dressings. The consultation must take place within 90 days following a **procedure** which **you** had as an **in-patient** or **day-patient** and which constituted **eligible treatment**.

4. Benefits

In-patient & Day-patient Treatment Benefit continued



In-patient and Day-patient Mental Health Treatment

Pre-authorisation of any *in-patient* or *day-patient* mental health *treatment* is required. If *you* receive this *treatment* on the *NHS* please see Section 4.5 (*NHS Hospital Cash Benefit*).



Prostheses

Prostheses may be passive or active and must be medically necessary as an integral part of *your procedure* and constitute *eligible treatment*.



Your Specialist must provide full details of *your* proposed *treatment* to *our* medical advisers for their authorisation in advance. *Your* proposed *treatment* must be *established treatment*.



Passive Prostheses

These are inert replacements of joints, blood vessels or other organs, e.g. hip or knee replacements or an aortic graft.

We will pay for:

- The *customary and reasonable* cost of the passive prosthesis.

For lens replacements:

- *We* will only pay for a monofocal lens. *We* will allow *you* to pay the difference in cost where an alternative lens is chosen.



We will not pay for:

- Artificial limbs;
 - Prostheses that are experimental or not, in the sole opinion of *our* medical advisers, in established use in the *UK*;
 - Complications which arise specifically from the insertion of a toric or multifocal lens;
 - Bespoke or customised joint replacements.
-



Active Prostheses

These are electronic implantable medical devices which are usually implanted permanently within the body to correct or modify an abnormal bodily function caused by an *acute condition*, e.g. pacemakers or defibrillators.

We will pay for:

- The *customary and reasonable* cost of the initial supply and fitting of such a device only to prevent the risk of potentially fatal organ failure, e.g. cardiac pacemakers or defibrillators.



We will only provide *benefit* for one electronic implantable medical device in the lifetime of each person to treat any condition/pathology of any kind in any single organ system, e.g. one device only for any condition of the heart.



We will not pay for:

- Any complication, regardless of the cause, including:
 - Any subsequent maintenance of the device;
 - Battery replacement or replacement because of ageing or technological advance;
 - Any failure in the device due to manufacturing, broken, malfunctioning, misplaced and/or displaced leads becoming evident more than 30 days after placement;
 - Internal or external muscle or nerve stimulators, implants intended to aid hearing or intracranial/cranial devices for neurological conditions such as epilepsy.
-

4. Benefits

Out-patient

A patient who attends a **hospital**, consulting room, or **out-patient** clinic for medical reasons and is not admitted as an **in-patient** or **day-patient**.

4.2 Out-patient Treatment

- (MH) The mental health **benefit** within this Section is subject to an overall maximum annual **benefit** limit. Please check **your Benefit Schedule**.
- (PC) This **benefit** is deducted from a primary care **benefit** limit.
- (X) **We will not pay for:**
 - Any **out-patient** drugs and dressings;
 - Any fees charged for cancelled or missed appointments.
- (!) For **cancer**, please see Section 4.4 (**Cancer Care**).

Out-patient Treatment Benefit

- (✓) **Consultations with a Specialist and Diagnostic Tests**
We will provide **benefit** for consultations with a **Specialist** and **diagnostic tests** such as x-rays, blood tests and ultrasound when referred by **your Specialist**.
- (✓) **Complex Scans**
We will provide **benefit** for MRI, CT and PET scans when referred by **your Specialist**.
- (✓) **Out-patient Procedures**
These are **procedures** which involve making an incision or using an instrument e.g. an endoscope to gain access to the inside of a patient's body; using an electromagnetic energy to treat a condition e.g. lithotripsy to treat kidney stones. **We** will provide **benefit** when carried out by a recognised **Specialist**, and in line with **customary and reasonable costs**.
- (✓) **Pre-admission Tests**
Tests carried out in **hospital** to check **your** fitness for **your** admission to **hospital** up to two weeks before **your** admission (such as blood tests, ECGs and chest x-rays).
- (✓) **Therapy** – see Section 4.3 (Therapy)
Carried out by a **Therapist** **we** recognise, on the referral of **your GP** or **Specialist** or on self-referral for physiotherapy via the **Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider**.

(MH) (✓) Mental Health Treatment

- (✓) **Out-patient Consultations**
We will provide **benefit** for **out-patient** consultations with a mental health **Specialist**.
- (✓) **Psychotherapy/Psychology**
We will provide **benefit** for **out-patient** consultations with a mental health **Specialist**.
 - When treated by a psychologist who is fully registered with the **HCPC**.
 - When treated by a psychotherapist who is an accredited member of the British Association of Behavioural and Cognitive Psychotherapists (BABCP), an accredited member of the British Association for Counselling and Psychotherapy (BACP), an accredited member of the UK Council for Psychotherapy (UKCP), an accredited member of the National Counselling Society (NCS), an accredited member of the Association of Christian Counsellors (ACC) or a full member of the Association of Child Psychotherapists (ACP) and hold (or have held) a post as a child Psychotherapist at Grade A in the **NHS** with at least five years' experience after qualification.

4. Benefits

Out-patient Treatment Benefit continued



Primary Care

We will provide ***benefit*** for Primary Care – as defined at Section 2.3 (Types of Care and ***Treatment***) this includes ***diagnostic tests*** arranged by ***your GP***.



Long-term Conditions

We will provide limited ***benefit*** for ***long-term (chronic) conditions***.

4. Benefits

4.3 Therapy

- ⓘ The **benefits** within this Section are subject to an overall maximum annual **benefit** limit. Please check **your Benefit Schedule**.
- ⓘ The mental health **benefit** within this Section is subject to an overall maximum annual **benefit** limit. Please check **your Benefit Schedule**.
- ⓘ **You** can **claim** for the cost of **eligible treatment** by a **Therapist** if **you** are referred to a **Therapist** by **your GP** or **Specialist**. For **cancer**, please see Section 4.4 (**Cancer Care**).
 - If **you** do not have a **GP** or **Specialist** referral and wish to **claim** for physiotherapy **treatment**, **you** may self-refer via the **Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider**. Please contact **us** and **we** will be able to assist with **your claim**.
 - In addition, if **you** do not have a **GP** or **Specialist** referral and wish to **claim** for mental health **treatment**, **you** may self-refer via the **Protocol Mental Health Pathway Provider**. Please contact **us** and **we** will be able to assist with **your claim**.
- ⓘ Please refer to Section 4.6 (Healthcare Pathways) for further details of the **benefits** under which **you** are able to self-refer.
- ⊗ **We will not pay for:**
 - Any fees charged for cancelled or missed appointments;
 - Any **diagnostic tests** and scans undertaken when referred by **your Therapist**;
 - Any drugs or remedies prescribed by **your Therapist** (e.g. medicines, lotions, supplements and herbs);
 - Medical appliances such as insoles or orthoses;
 - Group therapy **sessions**;
 - Counselling **sessions**.

Therapy Benefit

- ⓘ ✔ **Acupuncture**
When treated by an acupuncturist who has fully accredited membership of the British Medical Acupuncture Society (BMAS) or British Acupuncture Council (BAcC).
 - ⓘ ✔ **Chiropody/Podiatry**
When treated by a **Therapist** on the Register of Chiropodists/Podiatrists of the **HCPC**.

With our written pre-authorisation we will pay for:
 - Surgery to the forefoot by a Consultant Podiatric Surgeon who is a Fellow of the Surgical Faculty of the College of Podiatrists whose qualification is registered under the **HCPC** and who is employed as a consultant by the **NHS**;
 - Removal of ingrowing toenails (total or partial nail avulsion) by a Chiropodist/Podiatrist.
 - ⓘ ✔ **Chiropractic**
When treated by a **Therapist** on the Register of the General Chiropractic Council (GCC).
 - ⓘ ✔ **Dietary Services**
When treated by a dietician on the Register of Dieticians of the **HCPC**.
-

4. Benefits

Therapy *Benefit* continued



Homeopathy

Consultations with a homeopath who is an accredited member of the Faculty of Homeopathy (MFHom) or a Fellow of the Faculty of Homeopathy (FFHom).



Osteopathy

When treated by a *Therapist* on the Register of the General Osteopathic Council (GOC).



Physiotherapy

When treated by a *Therapist* on the Register of Physiotherapists of the *HCPC*.



Mental Health *Treatment* - Psychology/Psychotherapy

Please refer to Section 4.2 (*Out-patient Treatment*) for details.



Speech and Language Therapy

When treated by a *Therapist* on the Register of Speech and Language Therapists of the *HCPC*.

4. Benefits

4.4 Cancer Care

- ⚠ **Cancer** care is well provided for within the **NHS**, therefore the **Scheme** does not automatically provide **benefit** for private **treatment** of **cancer**.

Considerable investment has been made over the last few years to improve **NHS** services for **cancer** with the appointment of **Specialist** doctors and **nurses** to ensure that the best care is made available. Every patient with **cancer** is assessed at Multi-Disciplinary Team meetings to ensure that the right decisions are made for both investigations and **treatment**.

A swift diagnosis can have a significant influence on the **treatment** of **cancer** and the Clinical Specialist Team at **Protocol** will work with **you** in this pre-diagnosis phase to ensure that **you** obtain this.

Cancer Care Benefit

- ✓ **Diagnosis**
We will pay for investigations of symptoms leading up to a diagnosis of **cancer** including consultations with **your Specialist**, second opinions, **diagnostic tests** (including certain diagnostic genetic tests) and scans including ultrasound and biopsies. Following **your** diagnosis, **your Specialist** or **GP** will need to refer **you** to the **NHS** for **treatment**.
-

4. Benefits

4.5 NHS Hospital Cash Benefit

If **you** choose to receive: *in-patient treatment; day-patient treatment; out-patient complex scans; out-patient procedures or cancer treatment* as an **NHS** patient instead of as a private patient, **you** may **claim** a cash **benefit**. **Treatment** must be *eligible treatment* under the terms and conditions of **your Scheme** and eligibility for this **benefit** is subject to the limits set out in **your Benefit Schedule**.

- ⚠ If **your NHS in-patient** stay is preceded by an **A&E** admission, **we** will count the first night in **A&E** towards **your NHS Hospital Cash Benefit** as the first night as an **NHS** patient.
- ⊗ **We will not pay for:**
 - The following *out-patient treatment*:
 - Consultations with a *Specialist* and *diagnostic tests*;
 - *GP* referred *diagnostic tests*;
 - *GP* referred complex scans;
 - Pre-admission tests;
 - Therapy; and
 - *GP* referred therapy.
 - **Treatment** solely received in an **A&E** department.

NHS Hospital Cash Benefit

- ✓ **We** calculate payment as follows:
 - Per night for each night spent as an **NHS in-patient**;
 - Per day for each **NHS day-patient** admission;
 - Per day for one or more **NHS out-patient** complex scans (MRI, CT or PET), **NHS out-patient cancer treatment**: radiotherapy/chemotherapy **Targeted Cancer Therapies**, **NHS out-patient** blood tests or **NHS out-patient procedures**.
- To **claim** under this **benefit** please refer to Section 3.2 (How to make a **Claim** for a Cash **Benefit**).
-

4. Benefits

4.6 Healthcare Pathways

- (T) The **benefits** within this Section are subject to an overall maximum annual **benefit** limit. Please check **your Benefit Schedule**.
- (MH) The mental health **benefit** within this Section is subject to an overall maximum annual **benefit** limit. Please check **your Benefit Schedule**.

This section sets out the self-referred access to **treatment**/diagnosis services available to **you** via **your Scheme**.

- (!) If **you** miss an appointment for Self-referred Physiotherapy or cancel less than 24 hours before **your** appointment, it will result in this appointment being charged. A second or subsequent missed appointment, or failure to cancel with more than 24 hours' notice, will result in this appointment being charged and **your** access to the pathway will close.
- (X) **We will not pay for:**
 - Any fees charged for cancelled or missed appointments;
 - Any **diagnostic tests** and scans undertaken when referred by **your Therapist**;
 - Any drugs or remedies prescribed by **your Therapist** (e.g. medicines, lotions, supplements and herbs);
 - Medical appliances such as insoles or orthoses.

Healthcare Pathways Benefits

- (T) (✓) **Self-referred Physiotherapy**

Via the **Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider**, **you** will initially have a triage appointment to assess **your** condition, offer **you** appropriate advice and determine what **treatment** is most clinically appropriate. The **treatment** plan may consist of a home exercise programme, face to face/remote **treatment** with a physiotherapist.
 - (!) Once **you** have reached **your** maximum number of **sessions** via the **Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider**, if further **treatment** is required **you** must contact **us** for pre-authorisation and **we** can confirm if further **sessions** are eligible. If further **sessions** are agreed they will be deducted from **your** Therapy **benefit** limit and any Shared Responsibility will apply. Onward referral from the Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider and/or your GP/Specialist may also be required.
 - (!) If **you** need an onward referral to a **Specialist** in more complex cases, a **GP** must refer **you** and **you** will need to contact **us** with the **Specialist's** name and obtain further authorisation.
 - (!) If **you** choose to make use of the **Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider**, costs incurred will be deducted from the selected therapy **benefit** limit and will attract any applicable Shared Responsibility.
 - (!) This **benefit** is not available to **Scheme Members** under 16 years of age.
-

4. Benefits

Healthcare Pathways *Benefits* continued



Self-referred Psychotherapy/Psychology

We offer a quick and accessible service that enables **you** to get instant support and **treatment** without referral from a **GP**. The team of senior mental health practitioners will provide advice and ensure **you** are placed in the best **treatment** pathway.

Via the **Protocol Mental Health Pathway Provider**, **you** will initially have a telephone conversation with a mental health practitioner who will contact **you** at a conveniently agreed time. This call consists of an assessment, after which the options for the best evidenced and clinically appropriate therapy will be discussed with **you** to enable **you** to make an informed choice. If **you** require more specialist intervention for example from a psychiatrist appointment, **we** will arrange the appointment for **you** and support **your treatment** journey.

The benefits of this service include:

- Early intervention through prompt assessment by an experienced mental health practitioner;
- No **GP** referral requirement, avoiding unnecessary delays to **your treatment**;
- A choice of delivery of therapy, types of evidence-based therapy and local locations with experienced practitioners;
- Flexibility in appointments to suit **you**.



If **you** choose to make use of the **Protocol Mental Health Pathway Provider**, costs incurred will be deducted from the selected mental health **benefit** limit and will attract any applicable Shared Responsibility.



Self-referred Cancer Diagnosis Services

Via the **Protocol Cancer Diagnosis Pathway Provider** and without the need for a **GP** referral, rapid access to diagnostic services are available for suspected breast, prostate and skin **cancer**. **Benefit** will be provided for consultations with **your Specialist** including second opinions, **diagnostic tests**, complex scans and biopsies.

If **you** experience symptoms (such as a breast lump, dimpling and/or breast pain, or changes to a skin mark or mole or have had an elevated PSA (prostate specific antigen) blood test) simply contact **us**. **We** will take the details of **your** symptoms and, where appropriate, transfer **you** through to the **Protocol Cancer Diagnosis Pathway Provider** who will discuss **your** symptoms in more detail and arrange for **you** to attend one of their clinics for further **diagnostic tests**, as required. In the unfortunate event that **cancer** is diagnosed, **you** will need to contact **your NHS GP** for onward support. **Benefit** will be provided in line with the **cancer benefits** as set out within Section 4.4 (**Cancer Care**).



We will not pay for:

- Any tests, **treatment** or screening to determine **your** risk of developing **cancer** in the future.



In order to be eligible for the breast **cancer** diagnosis pathway, **you** must be aged 18 or over.



In order to be eligible for the prostate **cancer** diagnosis pathway, **you** must be aged 40 or over.



In order to be eligible for the skin **cancer** diagnosis pathway, **you** must be aged 18 or over.

4. Benefits

4.7 Gender Dysphoria

- ⚠ As Gender Dysphoria is a rapidly changing area, **we** align **our** provision of **treatment** with that offered by the **NHS**.
- ⊗ **We will not pay for:**
 - Any **treatment** which would not be provided to **you** under the **NHS** as an **NHS** patient.

Gender Dysphoria *Benefit*

- ✓ **Gender Dysphoria**

Subject to **you** meeting the **NHS** clinical criteria, **we** will pay **benefit** for Gender Dysphoria **treatment** recognised by the **NHS** on an **in-patient, day-patient** and **out-patient** basis if recommended by **your Specialist** in accordance with the overall maximum annual **benefit** limits applicable to **your Scheme** membership. Please refer to **your Benefit Schedule** for applicable limits.
 - ⚠ If **you** do make a **claim** for **treatment** for Gender Dysphoria, subject to **you** meeting the **NHS** clinical criteria, the following exclusions, detailed in Section 6 (What Is Not Eligible), will **not** apply to **your claim**:
 - 6.5 Breast surgery
 - 6.8 Cosmetic/aesthetic treatment
 - 6.19 Gender Dysphoria/Gender Incongruence
 - 6.37 Removal of healthy tissue
 - 6.41 Sexual problems
-

5. Further Benefits

5.1 Additional *Benefits*

Please refer to *your Benefit Schedule* for the amounts payable in relation to the following *benefits*.

- ⚠ Please see Section 3.1 (How to make a *Claim* for Private *Treatment*) except where stated in Member Offers.

Additional *Benefits*

✓ **Nursing at Home**

Nursing at Home is available under *your Scheme* provided that:

- It is recommended by *your Specialist* for a medical reason to permit *you* to leave *hospital* early, following an admission that *we* have authorised;
- The nursing care is arranged by *your Specialist* who remains in charge of *your treatment* and it must be provided by a qualified *Nurse*; and
- The nursing care is provided in *your* home.

✗ **We will not pay for:**

- Assistance simply for help with mobility or personal care.
-

✓ **Private Ambulance Transport**

There must be a medical reason for *you* to be medically supervised during the journey, for transport to, from or between *hospital(s)* for *treatment* which is *eligible treatment* under *your Scheme*.

✓ **Parent and Child**

Benefit for accommodation charges made by the *hospital* for one parent to accompany a child patient (who is also a member of the *Scheme*) when undergoing *eligible treatment* under the *Scheme* and recommended by the *Specialist*.

✓ **Oral Surgery**

- Fractures of the jaw and facial skeleton;
- Reconstructive surgery including plastic surgery following a dental injury;
- *Treatment* of a cyst;
- Odontome;
- Tumour of the mouth or jaw;
- *Treatment* of conditions of the salivary glands;
- Surgical removal of roots;
- Surgery to temporomandibular joint.

If *you* are referred to a *Specialist* *we* recognise *we* will pay for this under *your in-patient* and *day-patient benefits*.

The *procedure* must be carried out by a *Dentist* or *Specialist* *we* recognise.

✓ **AB InBev Guidance and Support Service**

Specialist 24/7 telephone support included with all levels of membership for *Scheme Members* and their *family member(s)*. See Section 5.3 (AB InBev Guidance and Support Service).

✓ **Member Offers**

A range of complimentary *benefits* are available for *Protocol* customers. To find out more and for any applicable terms and conditions please visit my.wpa.org.uk or use the WPA Health app.

5. Further Benefits

5.2 Cash *Benefits*

Please refer to *your Benefit Schedule* for the amounts payable in relation to the following *benefits*.

- ⚠ Please see Section 3.2 (How to make a *Claim* for a Cash *Benefit*).
- ⚠ Please see Section 3.6 (*Claims* Administration and Reimbursement) for information on claiming.

Cash *Benefits*

✓ **New Baby**

Upon the birth or adoption of a new baby *we* will pay a cash *benefit*.

- ⚠ To *claim you* must send *us* a copy of the baby's birth or adoption certificate within six months. *We* will make one payment per baby.

✓ **Hospice Donation**

When *you* are admitted to a hospice, a contribution will be considered to the hospice on *your* behalf, following notification of *your* stay from them.

- ⚠ To *claim* please contact *us*.

✓ **NHS Hospital Cash Benefit**

See Section 4.5 (*NHS Hospital Cash Benefit*).

5. Further Benefits

5.3 AB InBev Guidance and Support Service

With the hectic pace of life today **you** may sometimes face situations where **you** need additional information or help. But with busy work and home schedules it isn't always convenient to make a personal appointment with qualified professionals. With this in mind, **we** have set up the AB InBev Guidance and Support Service, staffed by a dedicated team ready to give **you** guidance and help with everyday situations, 24 hours a day, 365 days a year.

To use this **benefit** please call the helpline on 0800 093 8888. **You** can also visit **our** website at wpa.org.uk for general information, such as finding medical providers in **your** area.

- ⚠ The service is provided by Validium subject to their terms and conditions.

AB InBev Guidance & Support Service *Benefit*

- ✓ **Health and Wellbeing**
The occupational health **nurses** provide **employees** with information and guidance on lifestyle issues such as diet, exercise and sleep, as well as answering questions about health and medical matters, child care and eldercare issues.
 - ✓ **Counselling Support**
Counselling is a safe place for **employees** to explore personal or work-related concerns with professional support. This may take the form of counselling over the telephone, referral to face to face counselling, eCounselling, online resources or signposting to other agencies, as appropriate.
 - ✓ **Money and Debt Specialists**
A dedicated team is available for **employees** to access information on money matters, which may be affecting their welfare, including managing creditors, budgeting and debt management plans.
 - ✓ **Legal**
A specialist team of lawyers is available to provide **employees** with help and guidance on many different areas of personal law, including consumer, property, landlord/tenant, family and motoring law.
 - ✓ **vClub Online**
The vClub online Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) gives **employees** access to hundreds of downloadable help sheets, links to specialist resources and access to e-counselling.
 - ⚠ This service is not for enquiries relating to **Scheme** membership entitlement, **claims** or other healthcare trust enquiries.
-

5. Further Benefits

5.4 Overseas Emergency *Treatment*

⚠ **Your Scheme** only provides **benefit** for **treatment** in the **UK** except where this Overseas Emergency **Treatment benefit** applies.

⚠ This is not travel insurance but a restricted **benefit** for Overseas Emergency **Treatment**.

Any trips **you** make outside of the **UK** must not exceed a total of 90 days per **Scheme Year**.

We define Overseas Emergency **Treatment** as: unforeseen **treatment** that is due to a sudden, **acute condition** that, for medical reasons, cannot be delayed until **your** return to the **UK**.

The cost of Overseas Emergency **Treatment** will be paid in line with **your UK benefit** limits and is subject to the Shared Responsibility applicable to **your Scheme**.

In addition to **your UK benefit**, this **benefit** also includes: primary care **treatment** given by a **GP** or local equivalent and a **benefit** for evacuation or repatriation.

⊗ **We will not pay for:**

- Any **treatment** or **claims** that are eligible under a Travel Insurance policy;
- Any conditions (and/or **related condition(s)**/symptoms) for which, in the six months prior to travel (starting on the date of **your** outward journey) **you** have undergone **treatment**, or that have required **you** to visit any **treatment** provider including **treatment** for a condition that is terminal before **you** travel abroad;
- Any **treatment** required, whilst overseas, for or related to an infectious disease, condition or virus which has been deemed an epidemic or pandemic by the World Health Organisation e.g. COVID-19; SARS or Zika virus;
- Anything not within the terms and conditions of **your Scheme** as **eligible treatment** or **treatment** that is outside of the **benefit** limits under **your Scheme**;
- Any **treatment** whilst overseas or on **your** return to the **UK** for any condition contracted or injury sustained whilst in a location to which **you** travelled contrary to advice issued by the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office either as 'against all travel' or 'against all but essential travel';
- Any **treatment** needed because **you** did not take the necessary precautions e.g. vaccinations as advised on the **NHS** website: www.fitfortravel.nhs.uk;
- An accompanying adult or medical escort, once the person receiving the Overseas Emergency **Treatment** has been discharged from medical care, even if recommended;
- **Out-patient** drugs and dressings;
- Any **treatment** arising as a result of participating in dangerous activities/ circumstances such as taking part in winter sports of any kind or an accident or injury that occurs whilst on a winter sports holiday, or whilst staying in a winter sports resort, as outlined in Section 6 (What is Not Eligible).

5. Further Benefits

Overseas Emergency *Treatment* Benefits



Overseas Emergency *Treatment*

This **benefit** provides for eligible Overseas Emergency *Treatment* whilst travelling:

- Within the EEA and Switzerland; or
- Outside the EEA for business purposes only.

To be eligible, each trip must be no longer than 35 days starting the date of **your** outward journey. Overseas Emergency *Treatment* will continue until such time as medical advice indicates **you** are well enough to travel back to the **UK**, but no longer.

Treatment must be given by a locally recognised provider or in a locally recognised **hospital**. Locally recognised means recognised by the appropriate authority of the country outside the **UK** in which the **hospital** is situated or the **Specialist** or **Therapist** practices.

Before **you** travel:

- Contact the Department of Health and Social Care or visit their website to understand the reciprocal health agreements in place between the **UK** and other countries;
- **We** strongly recommend **you** have separate travel insurance for overseas travel.

If **you** are travelling in the European Economic Area (EEA) (and Switzerland):

- If **you** are entitled to a European Health Insurance Card (**EHIC**) or **UK** Global Health Insurance Card (**GHIC**) **you must** have one before **you** travel and use it where it is accepted;
- Where **you** receive Overseas Emergency *Treatment* in a European state funded facility **we** will only pay for **eligible treatment** costs that are over and above those included within the **EHIC/GHIC** or reciprocal health agreements that may apply at that time in the country where **treatment** occurs.

If **you** are travelling outside the EEA – for business purposes only:

- If **you** undergo private Overseas Emergency *Treatment* where the **EHIC/GHIC** is not valid or a reciprocal health agreement is not in place, **we** will pay the **claim** within the terms and conditions of **your Scheme**, subject to any other healthcare arrangement or insurance **you** may have. Please refer to Section 7.9 (What to do if **you** have healthcare with another provider);
- **Benefit** is only available if on a business trip. **We** will require confirmation from the **Scheme Holder** of the purpose of the business trip together with a copy of **your** business visa.

5. Further Benefits

Overseas Emergency *Treatment Benefit* continued



Medical Evacuation/Repatriation

If **you** are outside the **UK** and need eligible Overseas Emergency **Treatment** that in **our** opinion is not available in the country **you** are in, **we** will, through the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre**, evacuate **you** to the nearest suitable medical facility where the **treatment you** need is available.

- **We** may, in extreme circumstances, repatriate **you** to the **UK** for **treatment** where this is medically necessary and the Overseas Emergency **Treatment** cannot be obtained locally;
- **You** must accept **our** decision concerning the most suitable, practicable and reasonable medical facility, as **we** will not agree a transfer on **your** personal preference;
- In the event of the death of a **Scheme Member** or **Family Member**, the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre** will make arrangements (including the completion of any documentation) and pay for the return of the deceased to the **UK**.



No **benefit** is available for funeral expenses.



Family Assistance

In the event of medical evacuation or repatriation **we** will pay for the cost of immediate **family member(s)** who are overseas with the patient at the time of the illness or injury, and who are also insured under **your Scheme** membership to travel with the patient or return to the **UK** by the most appropriate means and by economy class.

How to Make a *Claim*



Your treatment must be pre-authorised by the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre**. The **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre** is a 24 hour service offering all major languages and they will be able to give **you** valuable help and advice. **You** must always contact the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre** straight away or as soon as **you** are able to do so. Call the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre** on (+44) 20 8680 3800.



It is also a condition of this **Scheme** that **claims** for **treatment** overseas must first be submitted to **your** travel insurer and then following their settlement, **we** will assess whether **we** can provide any **benefit** towards costs **your** travel insurer was unable to meet.

Payment for **your treatment**:

- Payment will be coordinated by **us** or the **Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre**;
 - Invoices totalling over £300 will only be paid to the **treatment** provider – not to **you** or to any representative on **your** behalf.
- Do not make payment for **your treatment** if the total payment is over £300 because **we** will not be able to refund **you**. If the payment is under £300, please send to **us** the original invoice and a receipt demonstrating proof of payment.
- In the event of a **claim** **we** will need details of any other healthcare arrangement or insurance policy providing any **benefit** for Overseas Emergency **Treatment** that **you** may have. **You** must agree to **us** contacting any other insurer. **We** will not pay for **treatment** or **claims** that are eligible under a travel insurance policy. Please refer to Section 7.9 (What to do if **you** have healthcare with another provider).
-

6. What Is Not Eligible



⚠ There is no **benefit** available to **you** or any **family member(s)** under **your Scheme** for **treatment** arising from or related to the exclusions in this Section.

⚠ These exclusions apply to all the **benefits** in this **Guide** and on **your Benefit Schedule** in addition to any **personal exclusions** (except where stated in Section 4.7 (Gender Dysphoria)).

Your Scheme does not provide **benefit** for:

6.1 Any treatment which is not established treatment. In addition, this includes:

- **Treatment** that is not approved by **NICE** for routine use in the **NHS** without restriction or is not routinely used in the **NHS** for this condition without restriction; and
- **Treatment** that involves the use of drugs outside of their **licensed indication** for the stage of the condition being treated. This may be either single or stipulated combination(s).

6.2 Any preventative procedure or treatment. This includes:

- Tests to determine if **you** have the existence of a condition including presence of a gene for which **you** do not have symptoms even if **you** have a family history of that condition;
- Removal of tissue for a condition for which **you** do not have symptoms even if **you** have a family history of that condition.

6.3 Any emergency treatment. This includes:

- Unforeseen and unplanned **treatment** that is due to a sudden, **acute condition** that for medical reasons cannot be delayed;
- Emergency **treatment** or emergency admissions into a private **hospital** including a private Accident & Emergency department:
 - **We** will not pay for emergency admissions into a private **hospital** unless pre-authorised and **you** have first had a consultation with a **Specialist** who has decided to admit **you**.
- Please see Section 2.6 (Emergency **Treatment**).

6.4 Allergic conditions

- Neutralising/desensitising diagnosed allergic and/or intolerance conditions;
- However **we** will provide **benefit** for the investigations to establish that an allergy and/or intolerance is the underlying cause of **your** symptoms.

6.5 Breast surgery

- Breast modification, including augmentation or reduction, whether for medical or psychological reasons in men or women, except **treatment** expressly permitted under Section 4.7 (Gender Dysphoria).

6.6 Certain hospital treatment

- Private **in-patient treatment** following an **A&E** admission to a **hospital** unless the transfer to receive private **treatment** is arranged by the **Specialist** at the patient's own request.
 - ⚠ **We** must authorise the transfer in advance otherwise no **benefit** will be available. Private **treatment** will only be eligible with effect from the date the patient signs the **hospital's** authorisation form;
- Private fees whilst being treated in **hospital** as an **NHS** patient;
- In a **hospital** overseas unless the Overseas Emergency **Treatment benefit** applies.

6.7 Complementary/Alternative Therapies

- With the exception of the Therapies listed on pages 14-15.

6.8 Cosmetic/aesthetic treatment

- **Treatment** intended to improve the patient's appearance whether or not for psychological purposes;
- Breast reduction or enlargement;

6. What Is Not Eligible



- **Treatment** required directly or indirectly as a result of cosmetic **treatment** (examples include but are not limited to breast augmentation, liposuction, botox, dermal fillers) or for performance enhancing **treatment** (examples include but are not limited to anabolic steroids);
- Any form of cosmetic dentistry (e.g. bleaching, veneers or implants);
- Save for **treatment** expressly permitted under Section 4.7 (Gender Dysphoria);
- However **we** will provide **benefit** for cosmetic/aesthetic surgery when needed as a direct result of an accident or injury when this forms part of an eligible **claim** that **we** have provided **benefit** for.

6.9 Dangerous activities

Any condition contracted, injury sustained, or **treatment** required:

- When overseas on a winter sports holiday or whilst staying in a winter sports resort; or
- When **you** return home having sustained an injury on a winter sports holiday/ at a winter sports resort;
- As a direct or indirect result of taking part or participating in a dangerous activity which includes:
 - Winter sports of any kind; or
 - Scuba diving; or
 - Motor sports.

⚠ If **you** are unsure if an activity falls within this exclusion **you** should check with **us** beforehand.

6.10 Dangerous circumstances

Any condition contracted, injury sustained, or **treatment** required:

- Either overseas or on **your** return to the **UK**:
 - Whilst in a location to which **you** travelled against advice issued by the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) either as against all travel or against all but essential travel; or
 - War, invasion, riot, revolution, act of terrorism, act of piracy, nuclear, biological or chemical contamination or any similar event.

6.11 Deliberately self-inflicted injuries or attempted suicide

6.12 Dental **treatment**

- General dental **treatment**;
 - Examples of dental **treatment** that are not eligible are routine dentistry, apicectomy (root filling), dental cysts or abscesses.
- **Treatment** of a condition which involves any teeth, their roots and surrounding tissue attachments where this forms part of the dental **procedure**. This does not apply to any **benefit** paid under the Oral Surgery **benefit**;
- Fees related to the supply of any dental prostheses;
- Orthodontic **treatment**, including the surgical removal of teeth for orthodontic reasons.

6.13 Developmental (physical or psychological), behavioural or educational conditions (or speech disorders arising from these)

6.14 Dialysis

- **We** will however provide **benefit** for a maximum of 28 days haemofiltration within the **benefits** for **Critical Care**: Level 3, or 28 days for haemodialysis, because of sudden kidney injury (failure) due to an eligible **acute condition**.

6. What Is Not Eligible



6.15 Drooping eyelids (ptosis)

- **We** will only pay for ptosis (drooping eyelids) if **your** optometrist identifies visual impairment and **you** are referred by **your** optometrist to a consultant ophthalmologist. **We** will only pay for surgery if **your** field defects, as identified by the optometrist, breach the DVLA requirements for visual field testing for safe driving.

6.16 End of life care

- Please see Section 8 (Definitions – *end of life care*).

6.17 Excluded conditions

- Anything excluded by the terms and conditions of **your Scheme**;
- Any **personal exclusion** applied to **your Scheme** by **us** when it was underwritten. Please refer to **your Certificate of Participation** and Section 7.4 (Underwriting Terms);
- Any **related condition(s)**.

6.18 Fees that are over and above those of customary and reasonable [cost levels](#)

6.19 Gender Dysphoria/Gender Incongruence

6.20 Gene Therapy Medicinal Products

- Such as (but not limited to) CAR-T therapy and Luxturna.

6.21 Genetic tests

6.22 HIV, AIDS

- Or similar or consequential infections, injuries or illnesses.

6.23 Home Visits

- Home visits by any healthcare professional, unless medically necessary and agreed in advance by **us**.

6.24 Long-term conditions

(also referred to as long-term (chronic))

- ⓘ This rule will apply once **you** have used the **benefit** for **long-term (chronic) conditions** as shown on the **Benefit Schedule**.

- **Your Scheme** provides **benefit** for the short-term **treatment** of **acute conditions** which start after **you** have taken out the **Scheme**;
- **Your Scheme** does not provide **benefit** for **treatment** for conditions that keep on coming back or need long-term monitoring or management. Including but not limited to: Alzheimer's Disease, Charcot Marie Tooth Disease, Crohn's Disease, Diabetes, Fibromyalgia, Glaucoma, Haemophilia, Juvenile Arthritis, Macular Degeneration, Recurrent back and joint problems, Recurrent Urinary Tract Infections, Rheumatoid Arthritis, Ulcerative Colitis;
- If **your treatment** becomes recurrent, continuing or long-term, the costs of **treatment** for this **long-term condition** – including monitoring, management, consultations and check-ups – and associated conditions will not be included under **your Scheme**. **We** will write to let **you** know if this is the case;
- **We** will, for a period not exceeding three months, pay for initial investigations needed to diagnose a new **long-term condition** and the initial short-term **treatment** up to the point of stabilisation. **You** must always contact **us** for pre-authorisation;
 - Following the three month period, **we** will not pay for further investigations such as endoscopies that are primarily diagnostic or **treatment** for relief of symptoms relating to a **long-term condition** e.g. pain relief injections.

6. What Is Not Eligible



- We will pay for **in-patient treatment** of new, severe or life-threatening complications which have not been previously experienced in order to quickly return the **long-term condition** to a controlled state.

Targeted Therapies for long-term conditions

- **Targeted Therapies** are now being used for some **long-term conditions**. If **your Specialist** considers that **you** may respond to a short-term course of **Targeted Therapies** **you** must always contact **us** for pre-authorisation. In addition, **your Specialist** must confirm:
 - That the **treatment** is not readily available to **you** as an **NHS** patient; and
 - That the **Targeted Therapy** will be used within its **licensed indication** for the stage of the particular clinical condition.
- We will then, for a period not exceeding three months, pay for **eligible treatment**. We have produced an advisory leaflet about **benefit for long-term conditions**. If **you** would like a copy of this, please contact **us**.

6.25 Menopausal/Pubertal conditions

- **Treatment** arising from or related to the male or female menopause;
- **Treatment** arising from or related to puberty.

6.26 Newborn/congenital disorders

- **Treatment** for unborn babies/foetuses/ embryos;
- Any birth defect or congenital abnormality whether identified at birth or later in life. This includes, but is not limited to, conditions such as:
 - Patent Foramen Ovale (PFO), Bicuspid Aortic Valve and genetic disorders and/or abnormalities causing a pathological condition or syndrome, including chromosomal abnormalities and gene point mutations.

6.27 Non-disclosed conditions/symptoms

- Conditions and symptoms which **you** have not told **us** about when asked to do so when applying for **Scheme** membership or pre-authorising a **claim**. Please see Section 7.12 (Terminating or Cancelling **your Scheme** membership).

6.28 Non-established treatment and experimental treatment

- Please see Section 8 (Definitions – **non-established treatment** and **experimental treatment**).

6.29 Non-hospital establishments

- **Treatment** taking place in a **hospital** that is not on **our hospital** list. Please see Section 2.4.1 (**Hospital** Access);
- **Treatment** in convalescent, nursing or residential homes, health-hydros, nature cure clinics or similar establishments.

6.30 Obesity

- **Treatment** arising from or related to obesity and/or **treatment** for obesity, e.g. bariatric surgery;
- **Treatment** arising from or related to the removal of fat or surplus healthy tissue from any part of the body, even if this is for medical or psychological reasons.

6.31 Organ transplant(s)

A transplant is where a patient receives an organ or tissue from another person (surgically implanted or infused).

- Organ transplant operations, including investigations done before the operation or **treatment** needed as a result of the operation.
- However, **we** will pay for:
 - Cornea transplants, skin, ligament and tendon grafts and blood transfusions.

6. What Is Not Eligible



6.32 Out-patient drugs/dressings

- This includes any drugs and dressings **you** are given to take home from **hospital** unless they are needed to complete a short course of up to 7 days **treatment** (e.g. antibiotics, anticoagulant medication, pain relief).

6.33 Pre-existing conditions – subject to **your** underwriting

- Any condition, disease, illness or injury, whether symptomatic or not. This includes:
 - Anything for which **you** have received medication, advice or **treatment**; or
 - Where **you** have experienced symptoms, whether the condition has been diagnosed or not, before the start of **your Scheme** membership.

6.34 Professional sports

- Any illness or injury due to engaging in professional sport that is a sport where any fee, donation or benefit in kind is payable either directly or indirectly for playing, training or coaching.

6.35 Refractive eye surgery

- Refractive eye surgery for the correction of imperfect sight.

6.36 Rehabilitation

- **Treatment** helping towards improving physical and/or mental capacities, following illness or injury;
- However, **we** will pay for a short course of rehabilitation (not to exceed two weeks) immediately following an **in-patient** admission that **you** have had **treatment** for through **your Scheme**. **We** must specifically agree the extent of the **benefit** before rehabilitation starts and this will not be extended.

6.37 Removal of healthy tissue

- From any part of the body for any **indication** (including medical or psychological) examples include (but are not limited to) surgery for Gynaecomastia, Labial Reduction, Circumcision and Prophylactic Mastectomy or Prophylactic Oophorectomy to prevent **cancer**. Save for **treatment** expressly permitted under Section 4.7 (Gender Dysphoria).

6.38 Reproductive system

- Pregnancy, fertility problems, assisted conception, contraception, sterilisation and child birth.
- However, **we** will pay for **treatment** of the following specified conditions when they occur during pregnancy:
 - Ectopic pregnancy (where the foetus grows outside the womb);
 - Hydatidiform mole (abnormal cells growing in the womb);
 - Post-partum haemorrhage;
 - Retained placental membrane;
 - Medical and Surgical Management of Miscarriage and Removal of Persistent Products of Conception.

- ⚠ Please note that investigations into the cause of miscarriage are not eligible.
 - Physiotherapy.

6.39 Road traffic collision/illegal activity

- Any illness or injury due to a road traffic incident/collision where **you** were not suitably restrained and/or wearing/using appropriate protection, e.g. seat belt, helmet or suitable child restraint;
- If **your claim** for **treatment** results from an incident or injury which is or may be subject to criminal proceedings against **you** or conviction, including road traffic offences, then **you** must provide all relevant details and **we** will suspend payment of **your claim** pending the outcome of the proceedings. If **you** are convicted then no **benefit** will be paid.

6. What Is Not Eligible



6.40 Routine medical examinations, health screening or medical appliances, such as:

- Hearing aids, wheelchairs, crutches, braces or surgical orthoses.

6.41 Sexual problems

- A condition of sexual function however caused;
- Sexually transmitted diseases.

6.42 Sleep disorders

- Sleep disorders, including sleep studies or corrective surgery, e.g. sleep apnoea and snoring.

6.43 Varicose veins

- **Treatment** for thread veins and other superficial veins;
- If **you** have a **personal exclusion** for varicose veins, this will continue to apply indefinitely;
- Recurrent varicose veins;
- However, if **you** do not have a **personal exclusion** for varicose veins, **we** will pay for:
 - One admission per leg regardless of **treatment** type per person per lifetime of the **Scheme** membership;
 - One visit only for injections of residual veins after **treatment** to the main veins per person per lifetime of the **Scheme** membership, which **we** will pay for for up to six months after the main **procedure**.

7. Important Information

7.1 What is required of *you*

7.1.1 *Scheme Member* Criteria

In order to be able to join the *Scheme* as a *Scheme Member*, *you* must be an *employee* or other eligible individual of the *Scheme Holder*.

The *Scheme Holder* must approve all applications for *Scheme* membership.

You must remain registered with a *GP* whilst *you* are a *Scheme Member*. At all times the *GP* with whom *you* are registered must be local to the *Scheme Member's Address*.

7.1.2 *Family Member(s)* Criteria

With the consent of the *Scheme Holder* *you* may include *family member(s)* under *your Scheme* membership. Eligible *family member(s)* include *your* partner and any of *your* unmarried children. *Your* unmarried children must be under 21 when joining the *Scheme* or under 25 if they are in full-time education. Once *your* unmarried children exceed the maximum age limits they will be removed from the *Scheme* at the next annual renewal. *Family member(s)* must live at the *Scheme Member Address* (unless in full-time education).

7.1.3 *Your Information*

We reserve the right, at any time, to request of *you* and any *family member(s)* evidence of *your* identity, *your* occupation or any other criterion.

7.2 Residential Status

The *Scheme Member's Address* will be used for all *Scheme* membership related matters. *Family Member(s)* are not required to live at the same address as the *Scheme Member*, but the *Scheme Member's Address* will be used for all *Scheme* membership related matters.

You must notify *us* immediately of any change to *your Scheme Member's Address*. *Your Scheme* membership will automatically cease if *you* leave the *UK* for more than six months of the year or provide *us* with an incorrect or inaccurate *Scheme Member's Address*.

If *treatment* received is invoiced to an address which is not the *Scheme Member's Address*, or the address that *you* are registered at with *your GP* is not the *Scheme Member's Address*, then *we* reserve the right, in *our* sole discretion, to:

- Void *your Scheme* membership; and
- Recover any *benefit* paid.

7.3 Renewal

Only the *Scheme Holder* may renew the *Scheme*. After the *renewal date* of the *Scheme*, new terms and conditions will apply to *your Scheme* membership.

7. Important Information

7.4 Underwriting Terms

Underwriting terms are applied in addition to the terms and conditions of *your Scheme* contained within this *Guide*. Please refer to *your Certificate of Participation* to see which underwriting term has been applied to *you*.

- ⓘ When *we* refer to conditions in this Section the term also includes any *related condition(s)* and any undiagnosed symptoms.
- ⓘ It is important to note that if *you* have made a transfer from another healthcare arrangement, in order to have *Scheme* membership with *us* it will only be *your* underwriting terms that transfer. The terms and conditions of *your Scheme* may be different to *your* previous one.
- ⓘ If *you* are required to complete medical questions prior to joining, it is essential that *we* have all relevant information from *you* when applying for *Scheme* membership (or to add *family member(s)* to an existing *Scheme*); this may include information about symptoms that have not been diagnosed. If relevant information is not provided to *us*, *we* will not pay any *claim(s)* that *you* make in the future for that condition, or may even terminate or void *your Scheme* membership. If *you* are unsure whether *you* should have mentioned something on *your Application Form*, please contact *us* immediately.

We reserve the right at all times to write to *your GP* for information. Please refer to Section 7.5 (*Your Medical Information*).

There are different types of underwriting terms.

7.4.1 Full Medical Underwriting (FMU)

FMU means *your Scheme* does not pay for conditions that *you* already had when *you* joined, unless adequately declared to and accepted by *us*. *You* are also not eligible for *benefit* under *your Scheme* for any conditions, whether diagnosed or not, if these arise in the first 14 days after *you* joined *us*. *We* call these pre-existing conditions.

In the *Application Form* *we* ask *you* to give *us* details of *your* full medical history. *Our* underwriters review the information *you* provide to *us* and, for example, determine whether *you* have a greater than average risk of requiring *treatment* for any condition. Such conditions have underwriting terms, which *we* refer to as *personal exclusions*, placed on *your Scheme* membership. *Personal exclusions* are recorded on *your Certificate of Participation*.

This means that *you* will not be able to *claim* for:

- Any *personal exclusions* shown on *your Certificate of Participation* as well as the general exclusions in Section 6 (What Is Not Eligible);
- Any conditions that existed before the date that *you* joined *us*, that fall within the questions in the *Application Form*, unless adequately declared to and accepted by *us* in writing.

7.4.2 Medical History Disregarded (MHD)

MHD means that when *you* joined *we* did not ask *you* to disclose *your* previous medical history, or provide details of *your* previous medical underwriting, and no *personal exclusions* have been applied to *your Scheme* membership. This means that *you* are eligible to *claim* for conditions that existed before the date that *you* joined *your Scheme*.

7. Important Information

7.5 Your Medical Information

It is a term of **your Scheme** membership that **we** may access **your** medical record(s) and/or request a medical report from **your treatment** provider. **Our** entitlement to this information is governed by the Access to Medical Reports Act 1988 (AMRA).

If **we** require further information, **we** will seek **your** consent. **You** may choose whether or not **you** wish to give **your** consent. If **you** refuse to give consent then **we** will be unable to process any **claim(s)** **you** have made or may make and **your Scheme** membership may be terminated or rendered void.

We will reimburse up to £50 towards any fee **your GP** charges for providing **your** medical records or a medical report if **we** request these in support of **your claim**. **We** will not provide reimbursement where **we** request **your** medical records or a medical report in relation to **your** application.

Once **you** have provided **your** consent **you** have the option to view the information first. If **you** choose to view the information first, **we** will be unable to process **claims** **you** have made or may make until all the information is provided by **you** to **us**. If **you** do not provide all of the information requested to **us**, **your Scheme** membership may be terminated or rendered void.

If **your Scheme** membership is terminated or rendered void as a result of a failure by **you** to provide to **us** information **we** have requested **we** may recoup from **you** any amounts already paid in respect of conditions for which **you** have made a **claim** prior to the request for information. In these circumstances, **we** will also seek **our** costs of recoupment.

We may also require **your treatment** provider including **Specialist** or **Therapist** whose care **you** have been under, to supply **us** with any information **we** reasonably require in relation to **your treatment** details, costs, invoices submitted to **us** or in relation to the administration of **your Scheme** membership.

7.6 What **you** need to know about Protocol

7.6.1 Who are **we**?

Protocol is a company registered in England and Wales under Company number: 02755175. **Our** registered office is: Rivergate House, Blackbrook Park, Taunton, Somerset, TA1 2PE.

Protocol is a public limited company.

7.6.2 Regulation

Protocol is a wholly owned subsidiary of **WPA**.

7.6.3 What **we** do

Protocol is an administrator of Corporate Healthcare Trusts appointed on behalf of the trustees pursuant to an Administration Agreement.

7. Important Information

7.7 What **you** should do if **you** are unhappy and want to complain

If **you** are unhappy and want to make a complaint **you** should contact **us** using any of the contact methods in this **Guide** and detail **your** complaint. **Your** complaint will then be escalated to an appropriate line manager to deal with. The appropriate line manager will investigate the complaint and following the conclusion of the investigation issue **you** with a response.

This process is overseen by **our** Head of Complaints.

In the event of any dispute the trustees have absolute discretion and their decision is final.

7.7.1 Applicable Law and Jurisdiction

Your Scheme is governed by the laws of England and Wales.

In the event of any dispute, the **Scheme** is the subject of the exclusive jurisdiction of the Courts of England and Wales.

7.8 Enforcing **your Scheme** membership

7.8.1 Who can Enforce **your Scheme**?

Third party rights are excluded and the **Scheme** can only be enforced by **us** and the **Scheme Holder**.

No third party or **family member(s)** may enforce any term of **your Scheme** and **Scheme** membership. The provisions of the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 are expressly excluded from **your Scheme** and any document issued under this **Scheme**.

Neither this **Scheme** nor any document issued under or as a result of **your Scheme** are intended to confer any rights on any **family member(s)** or third parties.

7.8.2 Terms and Conditions

If for any reason, any terms and conditions or provisions within this **Guide** are deemed unenforceable, invalid or illegal, in any respect under law or regulation, the validity, legality and enforceability of the remaining terms and conditions or provisions in this **Guide** will not, as a result, be in any way affected or impaired.

Any failure to exercise, or delay in exercising, any terms and conditions or provisions within this **Guide** by **us**, will not operate as any waiver by **us**.

If **we** pay any **benefit** outside the terms and conditions of **your Scheme**, it does not mean that **we** are liable to continue to make payment in the future.

7. Important Information

7.9 What to do if **you** have healthcare with another provider

It is a condition of this **Scheme** that if, at the time of making any **claim** (or at the time of any **eligible treatment** for which a **claim** has been made) there is any other healthcare arrangement, insurance and/or cash **benefit** scheme paying all or part of the costs which are the subject of the **claim**, **our** liability under this **Scheme** shall be limited to a rateable proportion of any such **claim**.

For the avoidance of doubt, this includes any **benefit** provided by **your** credit card provider or similar.

If **you** have the **benefit** of membership of a healthcare arrangement, insurance and/or cash **benefit** scheme with an insurer **you** must tell **us** and agree to **us** contacting them. This is a condition of **your Scheme** because neither **we** in administering the **Scheme** nor the other party are liable to pay more than a rateable proportion of any **claim** for **eligible treatment**.

If **you** fail to provide **us** with details of any other healthcare arrangement or insurance from which **you** are eligible to **claim benefit** then **we** reserve the right to recover the rateable proportion from **you**.

The amount of any **claim** that **you** make must not exceed the cost actually incurred by **you** for the **eligible treatment you** have received.

It is a general legal principle that **you** are not permitted to make a profit from **claims**.

You may not be paid more than once in respect of the same expense.

7.10 What to do if **you** have a Personal Injury or Clinical Negligence claim

It is a condition of **your Scheme** that if **you** have a personal injury or clinical negligence claim, **you** agree to comply with **our**: "Claims Cooperation Procedure" which can be viewed on **our** website at: wpa.org.uk/injury

It is important that **you** understand the legal implications of the Claims Cooperation Procedure. If **you** are in any doubt as to the meaning, **you** must contact **us** or take independent legal advice as soon as possible.

If **we** fund any **eligible treatment** costs which were attributable to the fault or negligence of a third party and **you** make a claim, **you** must include the eligible **treatment** costs within **your** legal action.

We have a contractual subrogated right to take legal action on **your** behalf (and in **your** and/or where applicable **your family member(s)** name(s)) and **you** must cooperate with **us** in the exercise of that right.

7. Important Information

7.11 Personal Information, Financial Crime and Fraud

7.11.1 How we use information about you

We will hold and process personal data in accordance with the Data Protection Act 2018, including the General Data Protection Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2016/679) and any other applicable laws and regulations relating to the processing of personal data and privacy. This also includes any applicable guidance and codes of practice issued by the Information Commissioner's Office or any other relevant supervisory authority.

Before **we** provide services to **you** **we** undertake checks for the purposes of preventing financial crime, fraud, money laundering and to verify **your** identity. These checks require **us** to process personal data about **you**.

The personal data you have provided, we have collected from you, or that we have received from third parties will be used to prevent fraud and money laundering and to verify your identity. Details of the personal information that will be processed include e.g. name, address and address history, date of birth, contact details, financial information, employment details, medical and lifestyle information and device identifiers including IP addresses. Further, **we** use your personal data to administer **your Scheme** including underwriting, **claims** processing, assessment and statistical analysis and to improve **our** products and services. **We** take great care in the safe custody and use of personal data. **We** hold the ISO 27001: 2022 Standard – the International and British Standard for Information Security.

We do not share information about **you** with third parties other than to a limited number of essential people necessary to perform **our** obligations to **you**, including:

- **Your treatment** providers;
- **Our** trusted third party service providers;
- Other companies within the **WPA** Group including: WPA Ltd; WPA Healthcare Practice Plc; WPA Insurance Services Limited; WPA World Class Services (India) Private Limited and any others as notified from time to time.

In certain circumstances, when **we** are legally obliged to, it may be necessary for **us** to share information with HMRC and/or **our** Regulators.

We may also share medical information with someone acting on behalf of **you**, if incapacitated.

We never share information with third parties for marketing purposes.

For further details please visit **our** website at: wpa.org.uk/privacy

For anything else, including an up-to-date list of **our** Service Providers, please contact the Data Protection Officer for the **WPA** Group in writing or email: dataprotection@wpa.org.uk

7.11.2 Financial Crime and Fraud

To detect and prevent fraud, financial crime or improper **claims** **we** check details with fraud prevention agencies. Additionally, **we** work with other organisations, including insurers, to pool information about applications or **claims**. When **we** and fraud prevention agencies process **your** personal data, **we** do so on the basis that **we** have a legitimate interest in preventing financial crime, fraud, money laundering and to verify identity, in order to protect

7. Important Information

our business and to comply with laws that apply to **us**. Such processing is a contractual requirement of the services **you** have requested.

We, and fraud prevention agencies, may also enable law enforcement agencies to access and use **your** personal data to detect, investigate and prevent crime.

Fraud prevention agencies can hold **your** personal data for different periods of time, and if **you** are considered to pose a financial crime, fraud or money laundering risk, **your** data can be held for up to six years.

Where any potential financial crime, fraud or improper **claim** is suspected by **us**, notified to **us**, or identified by **us**, **we** will investigate. If **we**, or a fraud prevention agency, determine that **you** pose a financial crime, fraud or money laundering risk, **we** may refuse to provide the services **you** have requested or **we** may stop providing existing services to **you**.

A record of any financial crime, fraud or money laundering risk will be retained by the fraud prevention agencies and may result in others refusing to provide services, financing or employment to **you**.

If **we** conclude **you** have or any **family member** has committed fraud, financial crime or submitted an improper **claim** (or attempted to do so) then **we** reserve the right to notify the Trustee which may include an employer or **family member**.

If **we** obtain evidence of fraud, financial crime or reckless or deliberate misrepresentation in relation to **your Scheme** membership **we** will avoid **your** membership and refuse all **claims** and will not refund any administration fee paid. Further, **we** will take legal action to recover all losses to us or the Trustee including any **claims** **we** have paid, the interest on these sums and all associated costs.

Whenever fraud prevention agencies transfer **your** personal data outside of the European Economic Area, they impose contractual obligations on the recipients of that data to protect **your** personal data to the standard required in the European Economic Area. They may also require the recipient to subscribe to 'international frameworks' intended to enable secure data sharing.

7.11.3 Your Data Protection Rights

Your personal data is protected by legal rights, which may include **your** right to:

- object to **our** processing of **your** personal data;
- request that **your** personal data is erased or corrected;
- request access to **your** personal data.

For more information or to exercise **your** data protection rights please contact **us** in writing or email: dataprotection@wpa.org.uk

You also have a right to complain to the Information Commissioner's Office which regulates the processing of personal data. For more information please visit: www.ico.org.uk

Please note that **our** processing of **your** personal data is an essential requirement in order for **us** to provide services to **you** under the terms and conditions of **your Scheme**.

7. Important Information

7.11.4 Giving *you* information

Where *you* have 'opted in' *we* may advise *you* by letter, telephone, electronic mail or otherwise of *our* services or products which *we* believe *you* may be interested in. If *you* do not wish to receive such information please tell *us* at any time.

You have a right to know what information *we* hold about *you*. *We* may request an administration fee for supplying a copy of any personal information.

You must notify *us* of any changes to *your* personal information such as a change to *your* name, address or email to ensure *your* personal information is correct and up to date.

Subject to *your* chosen communication method, *we* use email as *our* primary method of communication when *we* need to communicate with *you* on *claims*, medical or administrative matters.

For security, all of *our* emails containing special category data are either hosted in a secure online account and *you* will be notified by email when *you* have a message, or are sent with an additional security feature in place.

Please remember that the email address *you* give *us* must be secure and not accessible by anyone else.

By providing *your* email address *you* are consenting to its use for services which may include the provision and/or receipt of *claim* and medical information as well as the administration of *your Scheme*.

In the event of any unforeseen circumstance, such as a pandemic, *we* may need to default to email communication on a time-limited basis.

7.11.5 *Our Personal Data Retention Policy*

We will hold and process *your* personal data whilst *you* are a *Scheme Member* so that *we* may administer *your Scheme*. Following termination of *your Scheme* membership *we* will be entitled to continue to hold and process *your* personal data for legal, regulatory and statutory reporting purposes such as:

- fraud detection and prevention;
- as required by *our* Regulators and HMRC;
- monitoring and improving *our* services;
- data analytics, market trends and benchmarking;
- calculating premiums; and
- such other purposes as may be agreed between *us*.

How long *we* will retain and process *your* personal data depends upon the reason for processing. Where *we* carry out processing following termination *we* will use reasonable endeavours to ensure the anonymisation or pseudonymisation of personal data in so far as such processing can be carried out in that form.

7.12 Terminating or Cancelling the *Scheme* and/or *your Scheme* membership

We reserve the right to terminate or cancel all or part of *your Scheme* membership, or to void the *Scheme*, and may not pay *claims you* have made.

7.12.1 Terminating or Voiding *your Scheme* membership

We may at any time terminate (and/or void) or change the terms and conditions of *your Scheme* membership or stop providing *benefits* under *your Scheme* membership if at any time *you*:

- Act dishonestly or fraudulently in relation to *your Scheme* membership and *us* (including without limitation as to the deployment and/or existence of any fraudulent devices or means whatsoever); or
- Recklessly or negligently mislead *us*, either intentionally or carelessly including giving *us* incorrect information or not disclosing information that might influence whether the *Scheme Holder* accepts *you* as a *Scheme Member*, and if so on what terms, including but not limited as to *Scheme* charges/fees/rates, or agree to pay a *claim* or any part of it; or
- *You* make or try to make a fraudulent *claim* under *your Scheme* membership; or
- *You* are abusive or threatening towards *our* staff; or
- *You* do not comply with the terms and conditions of *your Scheme*.

In any of these circumstances *you* must return any *benefit we* have paid.

Your Scheme membership will automatically become void and terminated and no *claims* will be paid if:

- *You* leave the *Scheme*; or
- *You* live outside the *UK* for more than six months in any year as provided for in Section 7.2 (Residential Status); or
- The Administration Agreement between *us* and the *Scheme Holder* is terminated.

7.12.2 Cancelling *your Scheme* membership

The cancellation rights in relation to the *Scheme* are detailed in the Administration Agreement between *us* and the *Scheme Holder*.

If you wish to cancel *your Scheme* membership you must contact the *Scheme Holder*.

8. Definitions

Some words and phrases used in this **Guide** have a particular meaning and this is explained in this Section 8 (Definitions). These defined terms may not all apply to **your** particular **Scheme**, depending on the **benefit** it offers.

Unless the context of a defined word or phrase otherwise requires, the singular includes the plural and vice versa.

8.1 Scheme Definitions

Active Treatment

Treatment that is of **curative intent** or to relieve acute symptoms, arrest disease progression or remove/destroy **cancer** cells.

Acute Condition

A symptom, disease, illness or injury that is likely to respond quickly to **treatment** which aims to return **you** to the state of health **you** were in immediately before suffering the disease, illness or injury, or which leads to **your** full recovery.

A&E

NHS Accident and Emergency.

Application Form

The document(s) that **you** completed and/or submitted to apply for **your Scheme** membership.

Benefit

What **you** are entitled to **claim** reimbursement for under this **Scheme** in respect of **eligible treatment**.

⚠ **We** will only provide **benefit** to a level **we** consider to be a **customary and reasonable** cost.

Benefit Schedule

The schedule of **your benefits** applicable to **your Scheme** and in force for the **Scheme Year** which details all applicable monetary and non-monetary limits.

Best Practice Guidelines

Guidance set by the Royal College of Radiologists, **Cancer** Multi-Disciplinary Team Meetings – standards for clinical radiologists or peer review measures set out by the Commissioning for Quality and Innovation (QUIN).

Cancer

A group of cells that are no longer responsive to the normal mechanisms that control cellular growth and division.

CCSD Code

Operations/**procedures** carried out by **your Specialist** are classified using the industry standard CCSD (Clinical Coding and Schedule Development) codes. For information visit www.ccsd.org.uk

Certificate of Participation

The certificate applicable to **your Scheme** membership and in force for the **Scheme Year** giving details of:

- The **Scheme Member**;
- The **Scheme Holder**;
- Registered **family member(s)**;
- **Benefit** options included;
- Underwriting terms; and
- Any **personal exclusions** that apply.

Claim

A request for payment of a **benefit** for which qualifying expenses have been incurred under the terms and conditions of the **Scheme** and in line with its terms and conditions.

8. Definitions

Clinical Trial

A formally constituted *clinical trial* in accordance with prevailing legislation and overseen by the Medical Research Council.

Critical Care

The Intensive Care Society provide 'Classification of Critical Care' guidance. For information visit www.ics.ac.uk

Curative Intent

Curative intent applies to *treatment* that is administered with a reasonable expectation both that it will restore the patient close to the state of health enjoyed prior to the disease being diagnosed, and expect the patient to be disease free five years after commencement of the *treatment*.

Customary and Reasonable

The level of fees for services carried out by *your Specialist* that *we* deem to be *customary and reasonable*. In assessing the *customary and reasonable* cost of a *procedure we* consider the complexity of a *procedure* and the time and skill involved in its performance. *Our* fee levels as set out in *our Fee Schedule* are regularly reviewed by *Protocol's* Medical Advisory and Clinical Governance Committee, whose medical members have both private and *NHS* consultant experience. *We* take professional advice from *our Specialist* advisers and through continuing dialogue with both the medical profession and professional *Specialist* bodies.

Day-patient

A patient who is admitted to a *hospital* or *day-patient* unit for medical reasons and because they need a period of medically supervised recovery but do not occupy a bed overnight.

Dentist

A *Dentist* who is registered to practice with the General Dental Council.

Diagnostic Tests

Investigations, such as x-rays or blood tests, to find or to help to find the cause of *your* symptoms. For the purposes of this *Scheme*, *diagnostic tests* also include ultrasound scans.

EAP Provider

The third party who provide the Employee Assistance Programme subject to their terms and conditions which may be amended from time to time.

EHIC

European Health Insurance Card or any future equivalent reciprocal health funding agreements. Please also see *GHIC* below.

Eligible Treatment

Established treatment for which the *Scheme* provides *benefit*, given by a provider of *treatment we* recognise for an *acute condition* which is not excluded by any *personal exclusion* and is within the terms and conditions of the *Scheme*.

Employee

Director, partner, proprietor, employed member of staff or other individual authorised by the *Scheme Holder*.

End of Life Care

Treatment which concentrates on controlling pain and other symptoms when the patient is near or approaching the end of life and *active treatment* for the causative disease is no longer considered effective or appropriate.

8. Definitions

Established Treatment

Treatment that is considered to be acceptable recognised clinical practice by **our** medical advisers and/or:

- It is approved by **NICE** for routine use in the **NHS** without restriction or it is routinely used in the **NHS** for this condition without restriction; and
- If it involves the use of drugs, they are used within their **licensed indication** for the stage of the condition being treated. This may be either single or stipulated combination(s).

Family Member

A person included within the **Scheme** who is the partner of the **Scheme Member** or who is related to the **Scheme Member** as a child dependant and lives at the same address (unless in full-time education).

Fee Schedule

Our schedule of fees which sets out the maximum amount **we** will reimburse for a **Specialist** as set by **us** at the **customary and reasonable** cost which can be viewed at wpa.org.uk/guideline

GHIC

UK Global Health Insurance Card.

GMC

General Medical Council.

GP

General Practitioner holding a current licence to practice whose name appears on the **GMC** General Practitioner Register.

Guide

This **Scheme** document.

HCPC

Health and Care Professions Council.

Histologically/Genetically Distinct

Every **cancer** has a unique “footprint” that can be identified by examining tumour cells in the laboratory. One method is histology which is the microscopic study of tissues and cells.

Hospital

A **hospital** included in **our** list of recognised **hospitals** that is:

- A private **hospital** which charges fees for its services with facilities for providing private medical and surgical **treatment**; or
- An **NHS hospital** in the **UK** which is registered in accordance with United Kingdom legislation which is not a nursing home which provides convalescence or geriatric care;
- Or overseas is locally recognised.

Indication(s)

Authorised therapeutic use affirmed by the appropriate licensing authorities based upon the evidence-based submission for efficacy at product license application.

- ⚠ For malignant conditions, the specific type of **cancer** and stage of the disease need to be stipulated.

8. Definitions

In-patient

A patient who is admitted to a **hospital** and who occupies a bed overnight or longer for medical reasons.

Licensed

Any drug, medical and surgical appliance must be **licensed** for use in the **UK**.

Long-term Condition

A long-term (chronic) condition is a symptom, disease, illness, or injury that has one or more of the following characteristics:

- It needs on-going or long-term monitoring or management through consultations, examinations, check-ups, and/or tests;
- It needs on-going or long-term control or relief of symptoms;
- It requires **your** rehabilitation or for **you** to be specially trained to cope with it;
- It continues indefinitely;
- It has no known cure;
- It comes back or is likely to come back.

NHS

National Health Service.

NICE

National Institute for Health & Care Excellence.

Non-established Treatment or Experimental Treatment

Which is any **treatment**:

- That **NICE** does not recognise; or
- Which makes use of a drug outside of its **licensed indication** for the stage of the condition being treated; or
- Is any form of **clinical trial** whether formally constituted or not.

- ⚠ **Your Scheme** does not provide **benefit** for **non-established treatment** or **experimental treatment**.

Nurse

A qualified **Nurse** who is on the register of the Nursing and Midwifery Council (NMC) and holds a valid NMC personal identification number.

Out-patient

A patient who attends a **hospital**, consulting room, or **out-patient** clinic for medical reasons and is not admitted as an **in-patient** or a **day-patient**.

Personal Exclusion(s)

Specific term(s) that **we** may, in **our** discretion, apply to **your Scheme** membership based on either **your** lifestyle, **your** medical history or **your** family's medical history. These will be applied either when **you** take out **your Scheme** membership or on transfer and will appear on **your Certificate of Participation**.

If **you** are joining on a moratorium underwriting basis **you** will see **your** moratorium terms outlined in the **personal exclusions** section on **your Certificate of Participation**.

- ⚠ **We** reserve the right to add retrospective **personal exclusions** to **your Scheme** if **we** become aware of information **you** did not provide on **your** medical declaration.

8. Definitions

Procedure

A **procedure** that includes any of the following:

- Making an incision to gain access to the inside of a patient's body;
- Using an instrument (such as an endoscope) to gain access to and view the inside of a patient's body;
- Using electromagnetic energy to treat a condition, e.g. lithotripsy to treat kidney stones.

Note: these **procedures** are classified by **CCSD Codes**.

Protocol

WPA Protocol Plc, Rivergate House, Blackbrook Park, Taunton, Somerset, TA1 2PE and, where applicable, any other company within the **WPA Group**.

Protocol Cancer Diagnosis Pathway Provider

The third party who provides **cancer** diagnosis services subject to their terms and conditions which may be amended from time to time.

- ⚠ **We** reserve the right to change the **cancer** diagnosis provider without prior notice.

Protocol Mental Health Pathway Provider

The third party who provides mental health services subject to their terms and conditions which may be amended from time to time.

- ⚠ **We** reserve the right to change the mental health provider without prior notice.

Protocol Musculoskeletal Pathway Provider

The third party who provides musculoskeletal services subject to their terms and conditions which may be amended from time to time.

- ⚠ **We** reserve the right to change the musculoskeletal pathway provider without prior notice.

Protocol Worldwide Coordination Centre

The 24 hour service which **you** must contact in order to make an Overseas Emergency **Treatment claim**.

Related Condition

A **related condition** is where a reasonable body of scientific medical opinion considers another symptom, disease, illness or injury to be related to or associated with an excluded condition.

For guidance regarding what **we** consider to be related to some long-term conditions please visit: wpa.org.uk/relatedconditions

Remission of Cancer

A clinical state in which there is no objective evidence of **cancer**.

Renewal Date

12 months following the start of the **Scheme** as shown on the **Certificate of Participation**.

Retiree

An individual who was an **Employee** who has since retired but is authorised by the **Scheme Holder** to continue as a **Scheme Member**.

8. Definitions

Scheme

The **Scheme** is the healthcare **Scheme** provided by and in accordance with the terms and conditions of the Healthcare Trust. The **Scheme** is administered by **Protocol** as set out in the terms and conditions contained in this **Guide**, the **Benefit Schedule**, **Certificate of Participation** and where applicable any other endorsement or memorandum issued by **Protocol**.

Scheme Holder

The Trustees of the Healthcare Trust that entered into the Administration Agreement with **Protocol**.

Scheme Member

Any eligible individual actively involved in the business of the **Scheme Holder** as an **employee** or **retiree** and registered on the **Scheme**.

Scheme Member's Address

The **UK** address **you** provided to **us**. If **you** have one or more addresses, **you** should provide **us** with **your** usual residence where **you** and **your family member(s)** live for at least six months of the year. The **Scheme Member's Address** and the address **you** register with **your NHS GP** must be the same.

Scheme Year

The **Scheme** lasts for 12 months commencing on the start date set out in **your Certificate of Participation**.

Session

A maximum of one per day in a series of short daily **treatments**, e.g. physiotherapy or radiotherapy.

Specialist

A medical practitioner (including an anaesthetist) who is registered with **Protocol** who holds a licence to practise and whose name appears on the current **GMC Specialist** Register and is certified as a **Specialist** in the particular field by an appropriate college or specialty body providing a regulatory function.

Targeted Cancer Therapies (TCTs)

These are drugs or other substances that block the growth and spread of **cancer** by interfering with specific molecules (also referred to as "molecular targets") that are involved in the growth, progression and spread of **cancer**. This includes, but is not limited to monoclonal antibodies, **cancer** growth blockers, drugs that block **cancer** blood vessel growth, PARP inhibitors and immunotherapy.

Targeted Therapies

These are drugs or other substances that interfere with specific molecules ("molecular targets") that are involved in the growth of rapidly dividing cells. Although such cells are always a feature of malignant processes, they are also involved in some benign inflammatory conditions of the joints, the bowel, the nervous system and the skin, where **targeted therapies** are increasingly being used for **treatment**.

Therapist

A **treatment** provider fully registered with the appropriate professional body.

Transfer

When a **Scheme Member** or **family member(s)** changes **benefit** level or moves from one **Scheme** to another.

8. Definitions

Treatment

Surgical or medical services (including *diagnostic tests*) that are needed to investigate, relieve and/or cure a symptom, disease, illness or injury. This includes any form of medical care.

UK

When reading this *Guide* references to the *UK* include England, Wales, Scotland, Northern Ireland and where applicable equivalent services or guidance in the Crown Dependencies of the Channel Islands and the Isle of Man.

Us/We/Our

WPA Protocol Plc, Rivergate House, Blackbrook Park, Taunton, Somerset, TA1 2PE, as the *Scheme* administrator.

WPA

Western Provident Association Limited, Rivergate House, Blackbrook Park, Taunton, Somerset, TA1 2PE.

You/Your

The person (*Scheme Member*) named on the *Certificate of Participation* and any registered *family member(s)*.

9. Directory

Useful contact numbers

01823 625328	Customer Service Team
0800 093 8888	Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)
(+44) 20 8680 3800	Worldwide Co-ordination Centre

Email addresses

protocol@wpa.org.uk	Customer Service Team
financialcrime@wpa.org.uk	Email for details of our fraud prevention policy
dataprotection@wpa.org.uk	Email for details of our data protection policy

WPA weblinks

wpa.org.uk	WPA's website – full service and claim facility online
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Other useful websites

fco.gov.uk/travel	Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office
medical-acupuncture.co.uk	British Medical Acupuncture Society
osteopathy.org.uk	General Osteopathic Council
gcc-uk.org	General Chiropractic Council
cop.org.uk	Society of Chiropodists and Podiatrists
britishhomeopathic.org	British Homeopathic Association
bacp.co.uk	British Association for Counselling and Psychotherapy
bps.org.uk	British Psychological Society
psychotherapy.org.uk	UK Council for Psychotherapy
hpc-uk.org	Health and Care Professions Council
nice.org.uk	National Institute for Health and Care Excellence

Our standards are high

WPA has achieved four highly regarded and internationally recognised standards across our company. These standards reflect our service excellence provided to our customers, whether big global employers, medium sized businesses or the many thousands of UK individuals and families. We are independently audited by BSI and have been certified to:

Quality Management : ISO 9001:2015

The Standard for Quality Management systems placing emphasis on achieving customer satisfaction and continual improvement.

Business Continuity Management : ISO 22301:2012

A management system to restore our ability to supply critical services to an agreed level following a disruption to service.

Environmental Management : ISO 14001:2015

The Standard for Environmental Management systems – one of the highest benchmarks in environmental management and best practice.

Information Security Management : ISO 27001:2022

The benchmark for protecting valuable and sensitive customer information.



WPA Protocol Plc

Rivergate House | Blackbrook Park | Taunton | Somerset | TA1 2PE

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